Xiaohan Zou

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Education

Pennsylvania State University — State College, PA
Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering — 08/2023 - 05/2027 (Expected)

Boston University — Boston, MA
M.S. in Computer Science — 09/2021 - 01/2023

Tongji University — Shanghai, China
B.Eng. in Software Engineering — 09/2016 - 07/2020

Papers (also see Google Scholar)

Conference Papers

C1 **When Vision-Language Models Judge Without Seeing: Exposing Informativeness Bias**
Xiaohan Zou, Roshan Sridhar, Mohammadtaher Safarzadeh, Dan Roth
The Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2026, Main Conference

C2 **Understanding and Rectifying Safety Perception Distortion in Vision Language Models**
Xiaohan Zou, Jian Kang, George Kesidis, Lu Lin
The Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2025

C3 **Learning Conditional Space-Time Prompt Distributions for Video Class-Incremental Learning**
Xiaohan Zou, Wenchao Ma, Shu Zhao
IEEE / CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2025, ***Highlight***

C4 **StoryLab: Empowering Personalized Learning for Children through Teacher-Guided Multimodal Story Generation**
Zhaohui Li, Feiwen Xiao, Jiaju Lin, Xiaohan Zou, Qingxiao Zheng, Jinjun Xiong
International Conference on Artificial Intelligence in Education (AIED), 2025, Short Paper

C5 **Efficient Meta-Learning for Continual Learning with Taylor Expansion Approximation**
Xiaohan Zou, Tong Lin
International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN), 2022, ***Oral***

C6 **To be an Artist: Automatic Generation on Food Image Aesthetic Captioning**
Xiaohan Zou, Cheng Lin, Yinjia Zhang, Qinpei Zhao
International Conference on Tools with Artificial Intelligence (ICTAI), 2020, ***Oral***

C7 **A Survey on Application of Knowledge Graph**
Xiaohan Zou
International Conference on Control Engineering and Artificial Intelligence (CCEAI), 2020

Preprints

P1 **CARV: A Diagnostic Benchmark for Compositional Analogical Reasoning in Multimodal LLMs**
Yongkang Du, Xiaohan Zou, Minhao Cheng, Lu Lin
2026

P2 **Reconstruct before Query: Continual Missing Modality Learning with Decomposed Prompt Collaboration**
Shu Zhao, Xiaohan Zou, Tan Yu, Huijuan Xu
2024

P3 **TokenFlow: Rethinking Fine-grained Cross-modal Alignment in Vision-Language Retrieval**
Xiaohan Zou, Changqiao Wu, Lele Cheng, Zhongyuan Wang
2022

Journal Papers

J1 **Leveraging an LLM-Enhanced Bilingual Conversational Agent for EFL Children's Dialogic Reading: Insights from Children, Parents, and Educators**
Feiwen Xiao, Zhaohui Li, Jiaju Lin, Xiaohan Zou, Dandan Yang, Wenting Zou, Jinjun Xiong
Computers and Education: Artificial Intelligence, 2025

Industry Experience

LinkedIn Mountain View, CA
AI/ML Engineer Intern 05/2026 - 08/2026
Topic: Account Takeover Detection

Oracle Redwood, CA
GenAI Research Intern 05/2025 - 08/2026
Topic: Bias Mitigation in VLM-as-a-Judge (C1)

Kuaishou Technology · Intelligent Creation Team Beijing, China
Machine Learning Engineer Intern 07/2021 - 12/2021
Topic: Video/Image-Text Retrieval (P3)

China Electronics Technology Group Corporation Chongqing, China
Software Engineer Intern 10/2020 - 05/2021
Helped develop a security visualization system for an archaeological site. (Tech stacks: Vue, CesiumJS)

Banana Interactive Shanghai, China
Game Engineer Intern 10/2019 - 05/2020
Developed and maintained three HTML5 games. (Tech stacks: JavaScript, Affinity Designer)

Academic Experience

Pennsylvania State University State College, PA
Research Assistant 2024 - Present
Topic: Safety Alignment of Multimodal LLMs (C2)

Research Assistant 2023 - 2024
Topic: Video Continual Learning (C3) & Continual Missing Modality Learning (P2)

Boston University Boston, MA
Graduate Research Intern 2022 - 2023
Topic: Parameter-Efficient Continual Learning

Peking University Remote
Research Intern 2020 - 2022
Topic: Meta-Learning for Continual Learning (C5)

Peking University Beijing, China
Undergraduate Research Intern 2018
Topic: Semi-Supervised Machine Translation

Awards & Honors

Bronze, China Collegiate Programming Contest (CCPC) 2018
Second Prize, China Mathematical Contest in Modeling (CUMCM) 2017, 2018
Second Prize, Tongji University Programming Contest 2017, 2018
Second Prize, East China Normal University Programming Contest 2017

Professional Services

Conference Reviewer for AAAI, NeurIPS, CVPR, ICLR, AIED, BigData
Vice Chief Technology Officer & Chief Experience Officer at Tongji Microsoft Student Club 2018 - 2019

Teaching Assistant

PSU CMPSC 360 Discrete Mathematics Fall 2025, Spring 2025
PSU CMPSC 465 Data Structures and Algorithms Fall 2024

Skills

Programming Languages: Python, JavaScript / TypeScript, HTML / CSS, Java, C++, MATLAB
Tools and Frameworks: PyTorch, Transformers, Vue, React, Flask, Linux, Git, LaTeX
Languages: Chinese (native), English (proficient)